

Chapter 1 Basics concepts of hydrological models: routing

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To get more insight into the routing concepts explained in the theory, a computational guide is given here, leveraging both symbolic and numerical computing.

1 Reservoir cascade models

1.1 Cascade of linear reservoirs

1.1.1 First order linear reservoir with constant input

A linear reservoir with storage S [m³] and a constant input I [m³/s] is characterised by

$$S = KQ \tag{1}$$

with K [s] the residence time and Q [m³/s] the outflow. The mass balance equation is given by

$$\frac{dS}{dt} = K \frac{dQ}{dt} = I - Q \tag{2}$$

As this is a linear ordinary differential equation, it can be solved analytically using Laplace transforms (see your course in the 2nd bachelor year on [Differential Equations](#)). Remember that although the definition of a Laplace transform might seem complex

$$F(s) = \mathcal{L}\{f(t)\} = \int_0^\infty f(t)e^{-st}dt,$$

in practice you only need to apply a limited set of transforms to solve linear ODEs, which are summarised in the table below.

$f(t)$	$F(s) = \mathcal{L}\{f(t)\}$
$H(t)$	$\frac{1}{s}$
t^n	$\frac{n!}{s^{n+1}}$
e^{at}	$\frac{1}{s-a}$
$f'(t)$	$sF(s) - f(0)$

where $H(t)$ is the Heaviside function, which is defined as $H(t) = 0$ for $t < 0$ and $H(t) = 1$ for $t \geq 0$. n is a positive integer and a is a real number. Applying the Laplace transform to equation Equation 2 with $Q(t=0) = Q_0 = S_0/K$ and $q(s) = \mathcal{L}\{Q(t)\}$ gives:

$$K(sq(s) - Q_0) = \frac{I}{s} - q(s)$$

Isolating $q(s)$ gives:

$$q(s) = \frac{I}{s(1+Ks)} + \frac{KQ_0}{1+Ks} \quad (3)$$

We now need to apply the inverse Laplace transform to get $Q(t)$. Trivially, $\mathcal{L}^{-1}(q(s)) = Q(t)$. For the term containing Q_0 :

$$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\left(\frac{KQ_0}{1+Ks}\right) = \frac{K}{K}Q_0\mathcal{L}^{-1}\left(\frac{1}{1/K+s}\right) = Q_0e^{-t/K} \quad (4)$$

The term with I is a bit more convolved, but can be solved using partial fraction decomposition:

$$\frac{I}{s(1+Ks)} = \frac{A}{s} + \frac{B}{1+Ks}$$

To solve for A , multiply both sides by s and set $s = 0$:

$$\left.\frac{I}{1+Ks}\right|_{s=0} = A \iff A = I$$

To solve for B , multiply both sides by $(1+Ks)$ and set $s = -1/K$:

$$\left.\frac{I}{s}\right|_{s=-1/K} = B \iff B = -IK$$

Now we can apply the inverse laplace transform on the partial fraction decomposition:

$$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\left(\frac{I}{s} - \frac{IK}{1 + Ks}\right) = \mathcal{L}^{-1}\left(\frac{I}{s} - \frac{I}{s + 1/K}\right) = I - Ie^{-t/K} = I(1 - e^{-t/K}) \quad (5)$$

Combining Equation 4 and Equation 5 gives the final solution for $Q(t)$:

$$Q(t) = I(1 - e^{-t/K}) + Q_0 e^{-t/K} \quad (6)$$

E.g. for $Q_0 = 0.1 \text{ m}^3/\text{h}$ and $K = 7 \text{ h}$, we can plot the outflow $Q(t)$ for different constant inflows I . In the examples that follow, we'll use m^3/h and h for the units instead of the standard SI-units for convenience. Define the analytical solutions as a function:

```
# Imports
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import numpy as np
import sympy as sp
import scipy

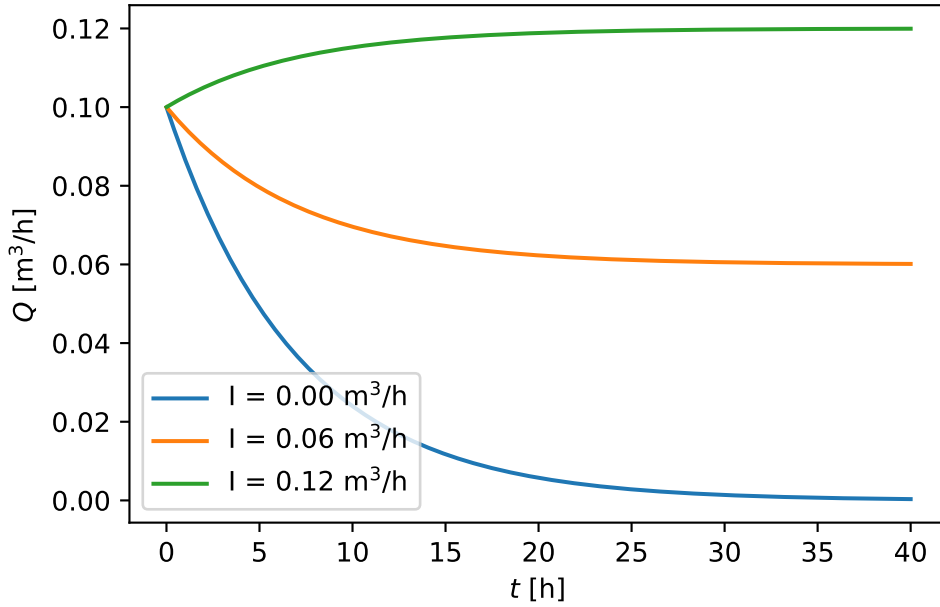
def Q_analytical_linear(t, I, K, Q0):
    return I * (1 - np.exp(-t / K)) + Q0 * np.exp(-t / K)
```

define the parameters and the three different inflows:

```
Q_0_num = 0.1 # m^3/h
K_num = 7 # h
t_array = np.linspace(0.01, 40, 200) # h
I_array = [0.0, 0.06, 0.12] # m^3/h
```

Note that all numerical examples that follow will use the value of K defined above. Now we can plot the results:

```
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
colors = plt.rcParams["axes.prop_cycle"].by_key()["color"]
for i, I_ in enumerate(I_array):
    Q_ = Q_analytical_linear(t_array, I_, K_num, Q_0_num)
    ax.plot(t_array, Q_, color=colors[i], label=rf"I = {I_:.2f} m$^3$/h")
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.set_ylabel(r"$Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
ax.legend()
```



Additionally, note that we can automate the algebraic routines above using [SymPy](#). First define all symbols:

```
K, I, Q0 = sp.symbols("K I Q0", positive=True)
t = sp.symbols("t", positive=True)
s = sp.symbols("s")
q, Q = sp.symbols("q, Q", cls=sp.Function)
```

and then define the ODE in the form $K \frac{dQ}{dt} - (I - Q) = 0$:

```
ode_linear = K * sp.diff(Q(t), t) - (I - Q(t))
ode_linear
```

$$-I + K \frac{d}{dt}Q(t) + Q(t)$$

Now take the Laplace transform of the ODE defining $q(s) = \mathcal{L}\{Q(t)\}$:

```
ode_linear_laplace = sp.laplace_transform(ode_linear, t, s, noconds=True)
ode_linear_laplace = sp.laplace_correspondence(ode_linear_laplace, {Q: q})
ode_linear_laplace
```

$$-\frac{I}{s} + K (sq(s) - Q(0)) + q(s)$$

We now insert the initial condition $Q(0) = Q_0$:

```
ode_linear_laplace_ic = sp.laplace_initial_conds(ode_linear_laplace, t, {Q:
    ↪ [Q0]})
ode_linear_laplace_ic
```

$$-\frac{I}{s} + K(-Q_0 + sq(s)) + q(s)$$

In the equation above, the only unknown is $q(s)$, which can be solved for:

```
q_s_solved = sp.solve(ode_linear_laplace_ic, q(s))[0]
q_s_solved
```

$$\frac{I + KQ_0s}{s(Ks + 1)}$$

Now apply the inverse Laplace transform to get $Q(t)$:

```
Q_solved = sp.simplify(sp.inverse_laplace_transform(q_s_solved, s, t))
Q_solved
```

$$\left(Ie^{\frac{t}{K}} - I + Q_0\right)e^{-\frac{t}{K}}$$

Which is identical to the analytical solution Equation 6 derived above.

1.1.2 Second order linear reservoir with constant input

We now get two reservoirs in series:

$$K^{(1)} \frac{dQ^{(1)}}{dt} = I - Q^{(1)}$$

$$K^{(2)} \frac{dQ^{(2)}}{dt} = Q^{(1)} - Q^{(2)}$$

The same SymPy approach can be extended to solve this coupled system. To simplify the solution, we'll assume:

- The second reservoir is initially empty, i.e. $Q^{(2)}(0) = 0$.
- The first reservoir has an initial outflow $Q^{(1)}(0) = Q_0$ as it is assumed non-empty.
- The first and second reservoirs have the same residence time, i.e. $K^{(1)} = K^{(2)} = K$.

We define two unknown functions and their Laplace transforms:

```
q1, q2, Q1, Q2 = sp.symbols("q1 q2 Q1 Q2", cls=sp.Function)
```

Write both ODEs in the form $(\dots) = 0$:

```
ode1 = K * sp.diff(Q1(t), t) - (I - Q1(t))
ode2 = K * sp.diff(Q2(t), t) - (Q1(t) - Q2(t))
display(ode1, ode2)
```

$$-I + K \frac{d}{dt} Q_1(t) + Q_1(t)$$

$$K \frac{d}{dt} Q_2(t) - Q_1(t) + Q_2(t)$$

Take the Laplace transform using $q_1(s) = \mathcal{L}\{Q_1(t)\}$ and $q_2(s) = \mathcal{L}\{Q_2(t)\}$:

```
ode1_laplace = sp.laplace_transform(ode1, t, s, noconds=True)
ode1_laplace = sp.laplace_correspondence(ode1_laplace, {Q1: q1})

ode2_laplace = sp.laplace_transform(ode2, t, s, noconds=True)
ode2_laplace = sp.laplace_correspondence(ode2_laplace, {Q1: q1, Q2: q2})
```

Insert the initial conditions:

```
ode1_laplace_ic = sp.laplace_initial_conds(ode1_laplace, t, {Q1: [Q0], Q2:
↪ [0]})
ode2_laplace_ic = sp.laplace_initial_conds(ode2_laplace, t, {Q1: [Q0], Q2:
↪ [0]})
display(ode1_laplace_ic, ode2_laplace_ic)
```

$$-\frac{I}{s} + K(-Q_0 + sq_1(s)) + q_1(s)$$

$$Ksq_2(s) - q_1(s) + q_2(s)$$

Solve the algebraic system for $q_1(s)$ and $q_2(s)$:

```
q_s_solved_2 = sp.solve([ode1_laplace_ic, ode2_laplace_ic], [q1(s), q2(s)],
↪ dict=True)[0]
q2_s = q_s_solved_2[q2(s)]
q2_s
```

$$\frac{I + KQ_0s}{K^2s^3 + 2Ks^2 + s}$$

To get a solution closer to the notation of the theory, we'll first break up into partial fractions:

```
q2_s_partial = sp.apart(q2_s, s)
q2_s_partial
```

$$-\frac{IK}{Ks+1} + \frac{I}{s} - \frac{K(I-Q_0)}{(Ks+1)^2}$$

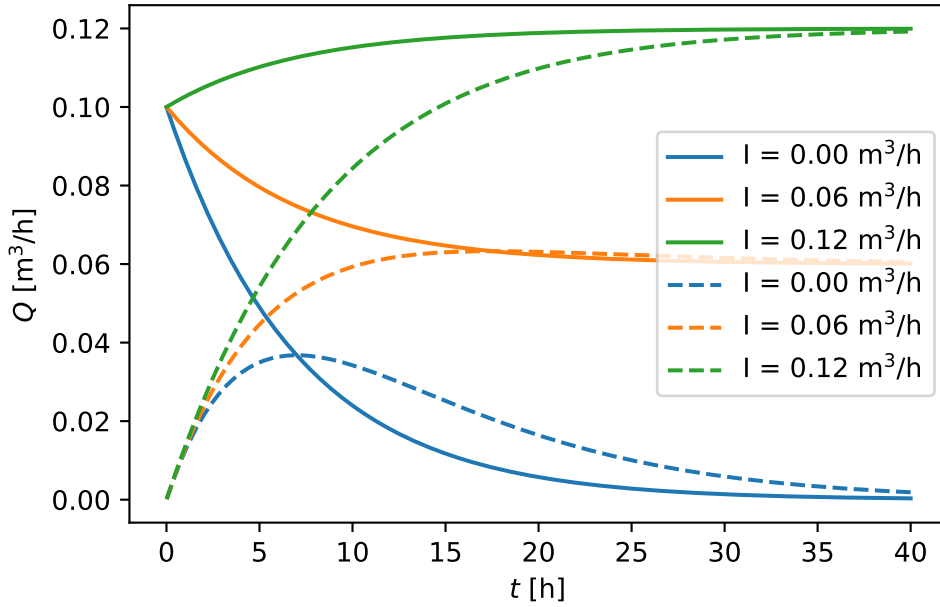
Finally, apply the inverse Laplace transform to obtain $Q_2(t)$.

```
Q2_solved = sp.inverse_laplace_transform(q2_s_partial, s, t)
Q2_solved
```

$$I - Ie^{-\frac{t}{K}} - \frac{t(I - Q_0)e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{K}$$

Also $Q_2(t)$ can now be visualised for different constant inflows I and the same parameters as before:

```
for i, I_ in enumerate(I_array):
    Q2_func = sp.lambdify(t, Q2_solved.subs({I: I_, K: K_num, Q0: Q_0_num}),
        ↪ "numpy")
    Q2_ = Q2_func(t_array)
    ax.plot(
        t_array, Q2_, label=rf"I = {I_: .2f} m$^3$/h", color=colors[i],
        ↪ linestyle="--"
    )
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.set_ylabel(r"$Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
ax.legend()
fig
```



In this figure, full lines are the output of the first reservoir and dashed lines are the output of the second reservoir. Note that the second reservoir has a delayed response compared to the first reservoir.

Given that the second reservoir is initially empty and receives no external input I , Q_2 is entirely defined by Q_1 and $K^{(1)} = K$. So if you solve for Q_2 (in the s -domain $q_2(s)$) with an assumed known $Q_1(t)$ function (in the s -domain $q_1(s)$), you get:

```
q2_s_bis = sp.solve(ode2_laplace_ic, q2(s))[0]
q2_s_bis
```

$$\frac{q_1(s)}{Ks + 1}$$

This concept can be generalised in what is called a **transfer function**, which is defined as the ratio of the Laplace transforms of the output and input of a system. In this case, the transfer function $H(s)$ is defined as:

$$H(s) = \frac{q_2(s)}{q_1(s)} = \frac{1}{1 + Ks} \quad (7)$$

1.1.3 n -th order linear reservoir with constant input

The concept of 2 reservoirs can be generalised to n reservoirs in series, with the general form of the ODEs given by:

$$\frac{dS^{(i)}}{dt} = K \frac{dQ^{(i)}}{dt} = (Q^{(i-1)} - Q^{(i)}), \quad i = 1, 2, \dots, n$$

Again, we assume $K^{(i)} = K$ for all reservoirs, $Q^{(0)}(t) = I$ and $Q^{(i)}(t=0) = 0 \quad \forall i > 1$. The easiest way to solve this equation is to use the transfer function concept. The first reservoir is a special case, as it has an external input I and an initial outflow $Q^{(1)}(0) = Q_0$. In the s -domain, $q^{(1)}(s)$ is given by Equation 3. $\forall i > 1$, the transfer function is given by a form analogous to Equation 7:

$$H^{(i)}(s) = \frac{q_i(s)}{q_{i-1}(s)} = \frac{1}{1 + Ks} \quad (8)$$

Consequently, $q^{(n)}(s)$ can be expressed as:

$$q^{(n)}(s) = q^{(1)}(s) \prod_{i=2}^n H^{(i)}(s) = \frac{q^{(1)}(s)}{(1 + Ks)^{n-1}} \quad (9)$$

In SymPy, this can be expressed as (reusing the previously solved $q^{(1)}(s)$ denoted as `q_s_solved`):

```
n = sp.symbols("n", positive=True, integer=True)
q_n_s = q_s_solved / ((1 + K * s) ** (n - 1))
q_n_s = sp.refine(q_n_s, sp.Q.gt(n, 1))
display(q_n_s)
```

$$\frac{(I + KQ_0s)(Ks + 1)^{1-n}}{s(Ks + 1)}$$

The inverse Laplace transform can be applied to get $Q^{(n)}(t)$:

```
Q_n_solved = sp.refine(sp.inverse_laplace_transform(q_n_s, s, t), sp.Q.gt(n,
↪ 1))
Q_n_solved
```

$$I\mathcal{L}_s^{-1} \left[\frac{(Ks + 1)^{1-n}}{Ks^2 + s} \right] (t) + KQ_0 \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \mathcal{L}_s^{-1} \left[\frac{(Ks + 1)^{1-n}}{Ks^2 + s} \right] (t)$$

Unfortunately, we run into a limitation of SymPy here, as it can't generalise the inverse Laplace transform for arbitrary n (try calling `sp.simplify` on `Q_n_solved`, it will crash). For specific values of n , we can still get the solutions

```

n_num_list = [5, 6, 7]
for n_num in n_num_list:
    print(f"n = {n_num}")
    Q_n_solved_specific = sp.simplify(Q_n_solved.subs(n, n_num))
    display(Q_n_solved_specific)

```

n = 5

$$I \left(1 - e^{-\frac{t}{K}} - \frac{te^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{K} - \frac{t^2e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{2K^2} - \frac{t^3e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{6K^3} - \frac{t^4e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{24K^4} \right) + \frac{Q_0t^4e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{24K^4}$$

n = 6

$$I \left(1 - e^{-\frac{t}{K}} - \frac{te^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{K} - \frac{t^2e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{2K^2} - \frac{t^3e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{6K^3} - \frac{t^4e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{24K^4} - \frac{t^5e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{120K^5} \right) + \frac{Q_0t^5e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{120K^5}$$

n = 7

$$I \left(1 - e^{-\frac{t}{K}} - \frac{te^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{K} - \frac{t^2e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{2K^2} - \frac{t^3e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{6K^3} - \frac{t^4e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{24K^4} - \frac{t^5e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{120K^5} - \frac{t^6e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{720K^6} \right) + \frac{Q_0t^6e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{720K^6}$$

From these solutions, we can easily identify the general pattern that can be expressed as:

$$Q^{(n)}(t) = I - Ie^{-t/K} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \frac{(t/K)^i}{i!} + Q_0e^{-t/K} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \frac{(t/K)^i}{i!}$$

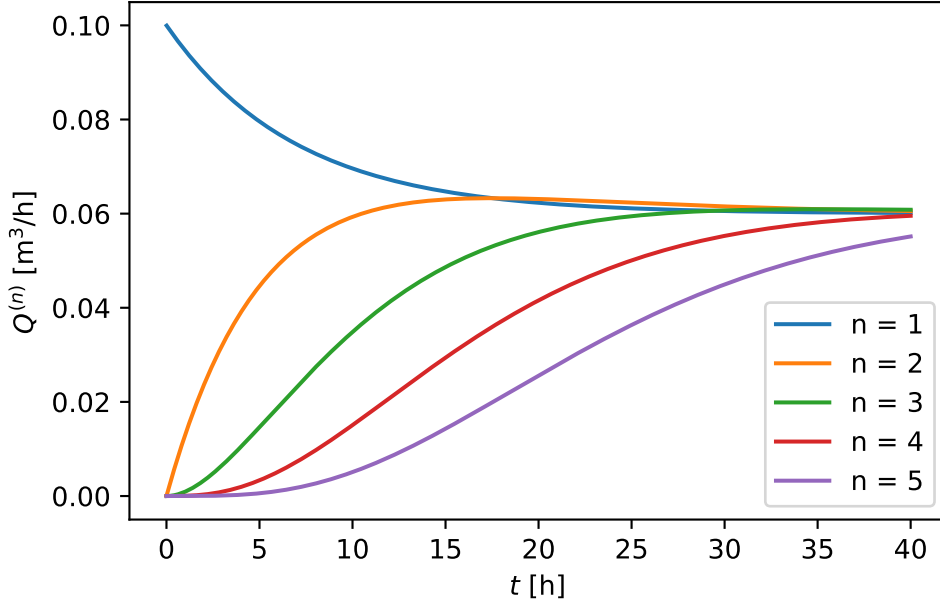
which is identical to the formulation in the theory notes. We can now also easily plot results for different n values

```

I_num = 0.06 # m^3/h
n_num_list = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
for n_num in n_num_list:
    Q_n_solved_specific_ = sp.simplify(Q_n_solved.subs(n, n_num))
    Q_n_func_ = sp.lambdify(
        t, Q_n_solved_specific_.subs({I: I_num, K: K_num, Q0: Q_0_num}),
        "numpy"
    )
    Q_n_ = Q_n_func_(t_array)
    ax.plot(t_array, Q_n_, label=f"n = {n_num}")

```

```
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.set_ylabel(r"$Q^{(n)}$ [m$^3$/h]")
ax.legend()
```



The larger n , the more delayed the response of the outflow is.

1.1.4 Nash-cascade

A Nash-cascade is a special case of the n -th order linear reservoir, where the input I to the first reservoir is a [Dirac delta function](#) $\delta(t)$:

$$\delta(t) = \begin{cases} \infty, & t = 0 \\ 0, & t \neq 0 \end{cases}$$

with

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \delta(t) dt = 1$$

It has the very useful property that $\mathcal{L}\{\delta(t)\} = 1$ ¹. Additionally assuming that the first reservoir is initially empty, i.e. $Q^{(1)}(0) = 0$, the continuity equation for the first reservoir of Equation 2 sets $I = \delta(t)$ and $Q(t=0) = 0$. The ODE can be laplace transformed:

¹Note that t needs to be defined between $-\infty$ and ∞ for this to be true

```

t = sp.symbols("t") # Generalise t for correct dirac delta transform!
I_dirac = sp.DiracDelta(t)
ode_linear_nash_1 = K * sp.diff(Q(t), t) - (I_dirac - Q(t))
ode_linear_nash_1_laplace = sp.laplace_transform(ode_linear_nash_1, t, s,
    ↪ noconds=True)
ode_linear_nash_1_laplace =
    ↪ sp.laplace_correspondence(ode_linear_nash_1_laplace, {Q: q})
display(ode_linear_nash_1_laplace)

```

$$K(sq(s) - Q(0)) + q(s) - 1$$

where we can clearly see that the Laplace transform of the Dirac delta function is 1. Inserting $Q(0) = 0$ gives and solving for $q(s)$ gives:

```

ode_linear_nash_1_laplace_ic = sp.laplace_initial_conds(
    ode_linear_nash_1_laplace, t, {Q: [0]}
)
q_1_nash = sp.solve(ode_linear_nash_1_laplace_ic, q(s))[0]
display(q_1_nash)

```

$$\frac{1}{Ks + 1}$$

So in the case of a dirac delta input, also the first reservoir has a transfer function of the same form as the other reservoirs (see Equation 8).

$$H^{(1)}(s) = \frac{q_1(s)}{I(s)} = \frac{q_1(s)}{1} = \frac{1}{1 + Ks}$$

Therefore, Equation 9 can be simplified to:

$$q^{(n)}(s) = \prod_{i=1}^n H^{(i)}(s) = \frac{1}{(1 + Ks)^n}$$

Transforming back to the time domain gives:

```

q_n_s_nash = 1 / ((1 + K * s) ** n)
Q_n_solved_nash = sp.simplify(sp.inverse_laplace_transform(q_n_s_nash, s, t))
Q_n_solved_nash

```

$$\frac{K^{-n}t^{n-1}e^{-\frac{t}{K}}\theta(t)}{(n-1)!}$$

In the above equation, $\theta(t)$ is the Heaviside function (cf. supra for definition). As we are only interested in $t \geq 0$ (i.e. after the input is applied) we can simplify the solution to:

```
Q_n_solved_nash_simplified = Q_n_solved_nash.subs(
    sp.Heaviside(t), sp.Heaviside(t).rewrite(sp.Piecewise)
)
Q_n_solved_nash_simplified = sp.refine(Q_n_solved_nash_simplified,
    ↪ sp.Q.positive(t))
Q_n_solved_nash_simplified
```

$$\frac{K^{-n}t^{n-1}e^{-\frac{t}{K}}}{(n-1)!}$$

Again note the equivalence to the formulation in the theory notes. Interestingly, the solution here assumes an empty first reservoir and a Dirac delta input, while the theory notes assume no input and a first and $Q^{(1)}(t=0) = 1$. The two assumptions are equivalent, as the Dirac delta input can be interpreted as a unit input to an empty reservoir.

Because the Nash-cascade is the response to an instantaneous input, it can be interpreted as an Instantaneous Unit Hydrograph (IUH)! Also note that the assumption that n is an integer can be relaxed to n being a positive real number. In this case, applying the inverse Laplace transform yields:

```
n = sp.symbols("n", positive=True, real=True)
q_n_s_nash = 1 / ((1 + K * s) ** n)
Q_n_solved_nash = sp.simplify(sp.inverse_laplace_transform(q_n_s_nash, s, t))
Q_n_solved_nash
```

$$\frac{K^{-n}t^{n-1}e^{-\frac{t}{K}}\theta(t)}{\Gamma(n)}$$

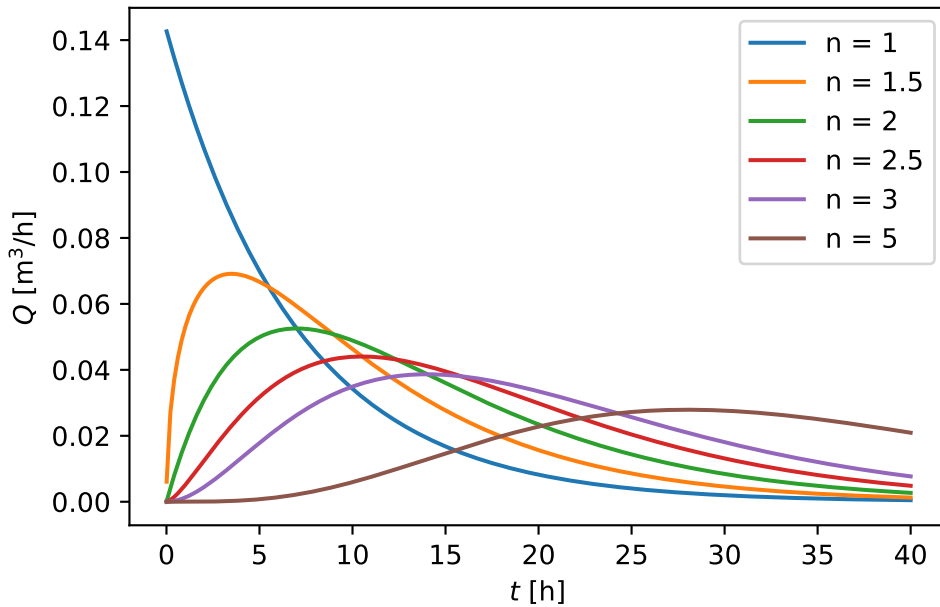
This allows n to be calibrated as a real number to match the geomorphological characteristics of a catchment. For completeness, we visualise the Nash-cascade for different n values, including non-integer values:

```
n_num_list = [1, 1.5, 2, 2.5, 3, 5]
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
for n_num in n_num_list:
    Q_n_solved_specific_ = sp.simplify(Q_n_solved_nash.subs(n, n_num))
    Q_n_func_ = sp.lambdify(t, Q_n_solved_specific_.subs({K: K_num}),
    ↪ "numpy")
```

```

Q_n_ = Q_n_func_(t_array)
ax.plot(t_array, Q_n_, label=rf"n = {n_num}")
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.set_ylabel(r"$Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
ax.tick_params(axis="y")
ax.legend()

```



Note 1: Application: routing via convolution

Defining $u(t) = \frac{1}{(n-1)!K} \left(\frac{t}{K}\right)^{n-1} \exp(-t/K)$ following the nash cascade, the outflow $Q(t)$ is given by the convolution of $u(t)$ with the input $I(t)$:

$$Q(t) = (u * I)(t) = \int_0^t u(\tau) I(t - \tau) d\tau$$

Note that this convolution concept is only valid because the system is **linear** and hence the **principle of superposition** holds!

Define a toy input $I(t)$:

```

I_array = [0.2, 0.5, 0.1, 0.2, 0.6, 0.8, 1.2, 1, 0.5, 0.2, 0.0] # mm/h
A_example = 10_000 # m^2, example catchment area
I_array_m3h = np.array(I_array) * A_example / 1000 # m^3/h
t_array = np.arange(len(I_array)) # h

```

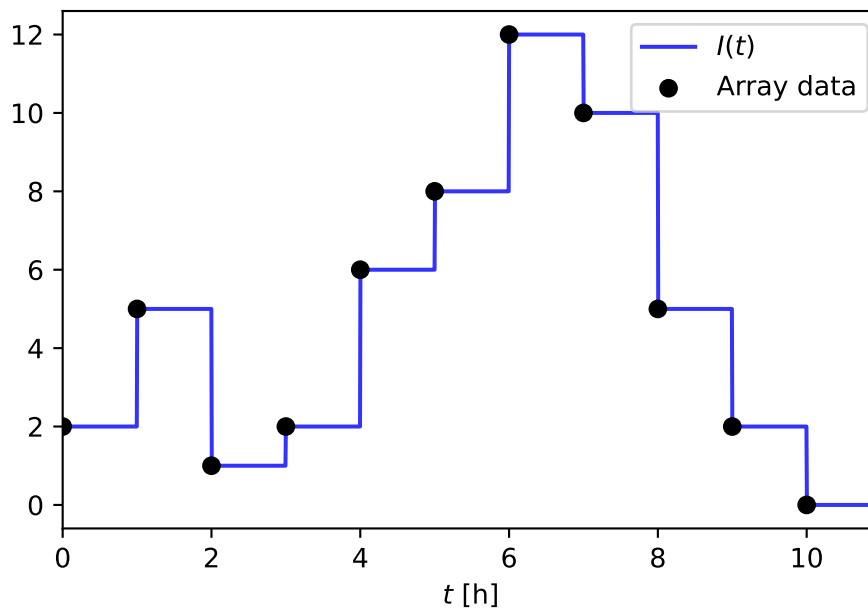
where each value represent the average rainfall intensity over a 1h time step. We can make a piecewise constant function of this input:

```
I_func = scipy.interpolate.interp1d(
    t_array, I_array_m3h, kind="previous", fill_value=0,
    ↪ bounds_error=False
)
t_eval = np.linspace(0, 60, 61) # h

# For plotting rainfall take higher resolution timeseries
t_eval_hr = np.linspace(0, 60, 10_000) # h
I_hr = I_func(t_eval_hr)
```

Where $I(t) = I_m$ during the time interval $[m\Delta t, (m+1)\Delta t[$, as illustrated below.

```
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
ax.plot(t_eval_hr, I_hr, color="blue", label=r"$I(t)$", alpha=0.8)
ax.scatter(t_array, I_array_m3h, color="black", label="Array data",
    ↪ zorder=3)
ax.set_xlim(0, np.max(t_array) * 1.1)
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.legend()
```



Now we can numerically integrate the convolution with `scipy.integrate.quad` to get $Q(t)$ for different n values:

```

u_nash_func = sp.lambdify((t, n, K), Q_n_solved_nash, "numpy")

def integrand_func(tau, t, n, K):
    return I_func(tau) * u_nash_func(t - tau, n, K)

Q_numerical_dict = {}
for n_num in n_num_list:
    print("Integrating for n =", n_num)
    Q_numerical_ = np.zeros_like(t_eval)
    for i, t_ in enumerate(t_eval):
        Q_numerical_[i] = scipy.integrate.quad(
            integrand_func, 0, t_, args=(t_, n_num, K_num),
            ↪ points=t_array[t_array <= t_]
        )[0] # Use points argument to handle discontinuities in I_func
    Q_numerical_dict[n_num] = Q_numerical_

```

```

Integrating for n = 1
Integrating for n = 1.5
Integrating for n = 2
Integrating for n = 2.5
Integrating for n = 3
Integrating for n = 5

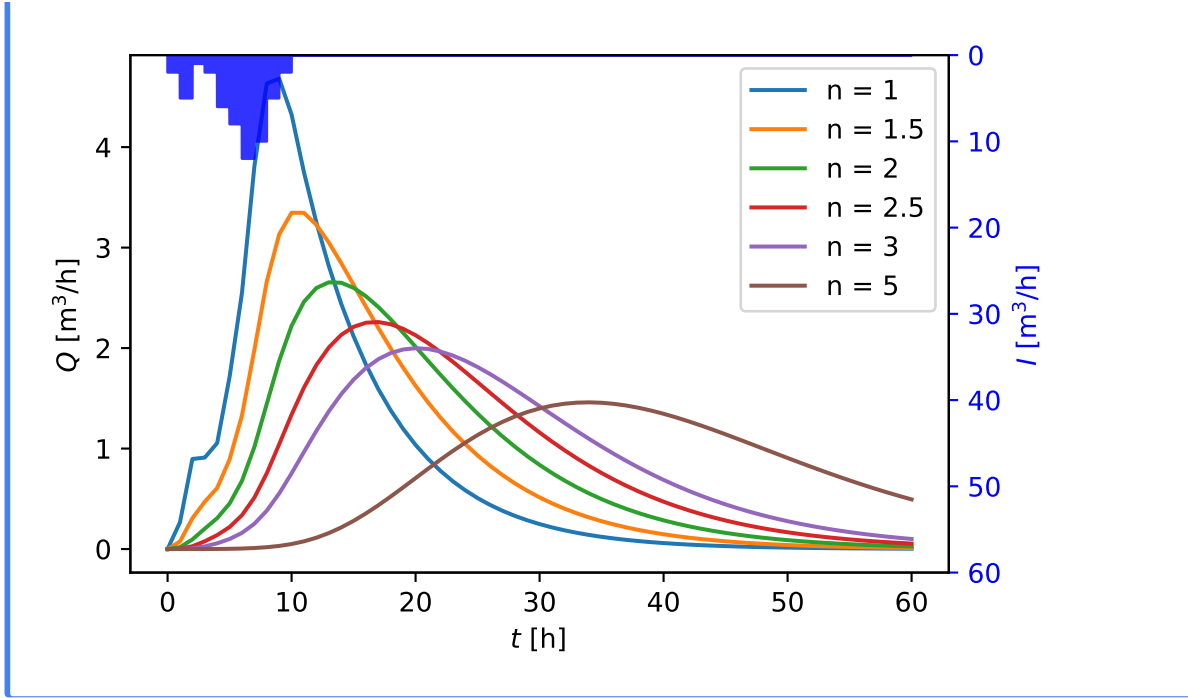
```

Now we can plot the input and output:

```

fig, ax = plt.subplots()
for n_num, Q_numerical_ in Q_numerical_dict.items():
    ax.plot(t_eval, Q_numerical_, label=rf"n = {n_num}", zorder=3)
ax2 = ax.twinx()
ax2.fill_between(t_eval_hr, I_hr, color="blue", label="Rainfall",
    ↪ alpha=0.8, zorder=2)
ax2.set_ylim(0, np.max(I_hr) * 5)
ax2.set_ylabel(r"$I$ [m$^3$/h]", color="blue")
ax2.tick_params(axis="y", colors="blue")
ax2.invert_yaxis()
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.set_ylabel(r"$Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
ax.legend()

```

1.1.5 Linear reservoir with time-varying input

For a linear reservoir with a time-varying input $I(t)$, the ODE is given by:

$$\frac{dS}{dt} = I(t) - \frac{S}{K} \quad (10)$$

For this case, there are 2 options:

1. Apply the convolution approach as shown in Note 1
2. Solve the ODE defined by Equation 10 numerically.

For details on numerical solvers for ODEs, we again refer to your bachelor course on Differential Equations. However, one must pay special attention to the fact the the input $I(t)$ is a piecewise constant function. For example, we consider the rainfall input to be constant over 1h ($= \Delta t_{in}$) xtime steps:

1. Fixed time step schemes: you choose the time step Δt of your solver to be equal to (or a integer fraction of) the Δt_{in} .
2. Adaptive time step schemes: the solver chooses a timestep Δt based on its estimate of numerical error. These solvers cannot handle discontinuities however. Therefore, you need to integrate in $[0, \Delta t_{in}]$, then in $[\Delta t_{in}, 2\Delta t_{in}]$, etc. and restart the solver at each discontinuity.

These concepts will be illustrated by retaking Note 1 below

Note 2: Routing via numerical ODE integration

Two different numerical solvers (representing the two classes above) will be used to solve the example from Note 1:

1. Explicit Euler method with $\Delta t = \Delta t_{in} = 1$ h
2. The explicit Runge-Kutta method of order 5(4) with adaptive time stepping control as provided by `scipy.integrate.solve_ivp` with the RK45 method.

We reuse the input function $I(t)$ defined in Note 1.

```
def ode_func(t: float, S: np.array, I_func, K: float):  
    return I_func(t) - S / K
```

We then implement the explicit Euler method:

```
def explicit_euler(ode_func, t_span:tuple, S0:np.array, delta_t:float,  
    ↪ args):  
    t_eval = np.arange(t_span[0], t_span[1] + delta_t, delta_t)  
    # Initialize the storage array: n_states x n_time_steps  
    S = np.zeros((len(S0), len(t_eval)))  
    S[:, 0] = S0  
    for i in range(1, len(t_eval)):  
        dt = t_eval[i] - t_eval[i - 1]  
        S[:, i] = S[:, i - 1] + dt * ode_func(t_eval[i - 1], S[:, i - 1],  
    ↪ *args)  
    return S
```

We can now solve the ODE with this method.

```
S0 = np.array([0]) # Initial storage  
t_span = (0, 60) # hr  
delta_t = 1 # hr  
S_explicit_euler_solution = explicit_euler(ode_func, t_span, S0, delta_t,  
    ↪ (I_func, K_num))
```

For the RK45 method we write a wrapper around `scipy.integrate.solve_ivp` to handle the piecewise constant input function.

```

def rk_45(ode_func, t_span:tuple, S0:np.array, args):
    t_eval = np.arange(t_span[0], t_span[1] + 1, 1) # Evaluate at integer
    ↪ hours
    S = np.zeros((len(S0), len(t_eval)))
    S_current = S0
    for i in range(len(t_eval) - 1):
        t_interval = (t_eval[i], t_eval[i + 1])
        sol = scipy.integrate.solve_ivp(
            ode_func, t_interval, S_current, method="RK45", args=args,
    ↪ t_eval=list(t_interval)
        )
        S[:, i + 1] = sol.y[:, -1]
        S_current = sol.y[:, -1]
    return S

```

```

S_rk45_solution = rk_45(ode_func, t_span, S0, (I_func, K_num))

```

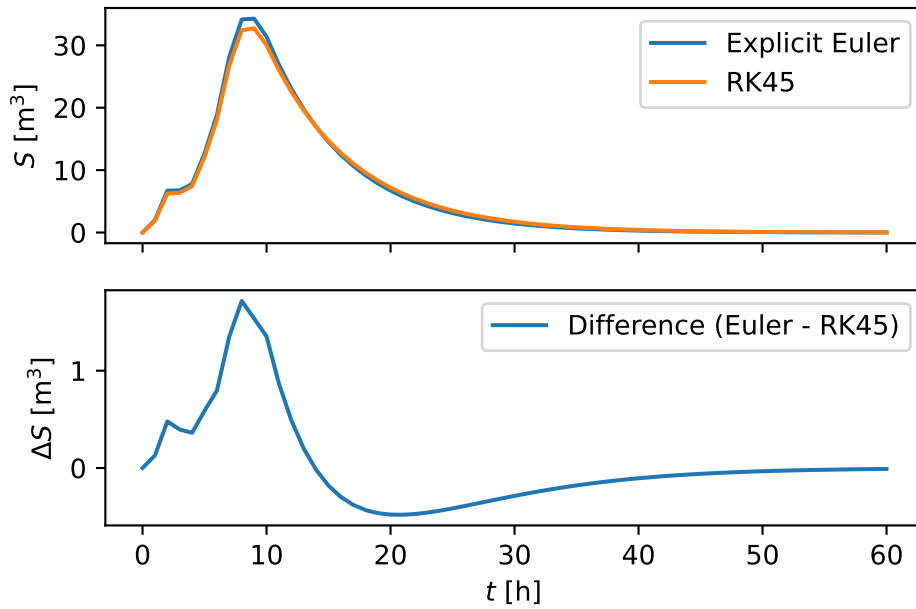
Now we can plot the results of both solvers:

```

diff_S = S_explicit_euler_solution - S_rk45_solution
fig, axes = plt.subplots(2, 1, sharex=True)
axes[0].plot(t_eval, S_explicit_euler_solution[0, :], label="Explicit
    ↪ Euler")
axes[0].plot(t_eval, S_rk45_solution[0, :], label="RK45")
axes[0].set_ylabel(r"$S$ [m$^3$]")
axes[0].legend()

axes[1].plot(t_eval, diff_S[0, :], label="Difference (Euler - RK45)")
axes[1].set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
axes[1].set_ylabel(r"$\Delta S$ [m$^3$]")
axes[1].legend()

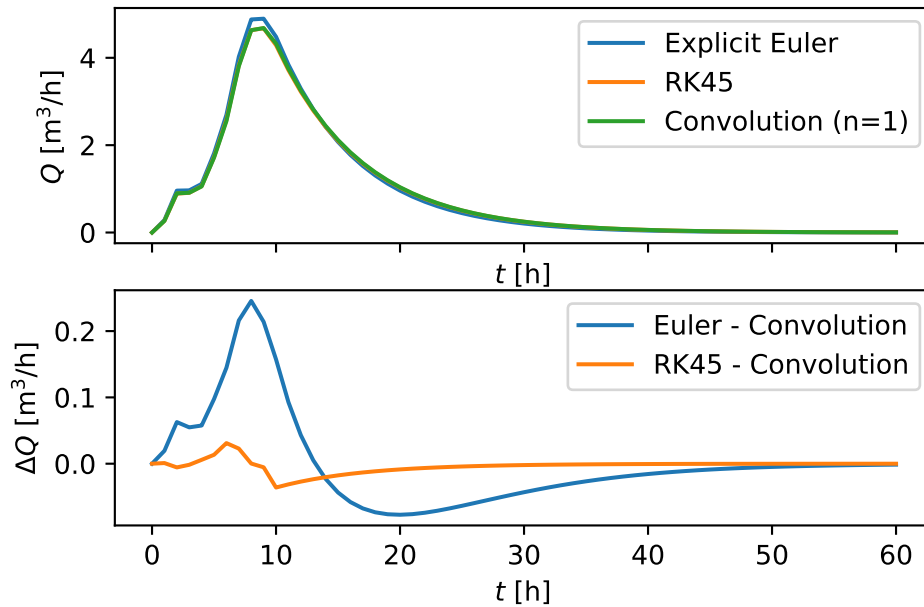
```



As $Q = S/K$, this difference directly translates to the outflow $Q(t)$. Below, we compare this Q to the convolution solution from Note 1 for $n = 1$

```
fig, axes = plt.subplots(2, 1, sharex=True)
Q_euler = S_explicit_euler_solution[0, :] / K_num
Q_rk45 = S_rk45_solution[0, :] / K_num
Q_convolution = Q_numerical_dict[1]
axes[0].plot(t_eval, Q_euler, label="Explicit Euler")
axes[0].plot(t_eval, Q_rk45, label="RK45")
axes[0].plot(t_eval, Q_convolution, label="Convolution (n=1)")
axes[0].set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
axes[0].set_ylabel(r"$Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
axes[0].legend()

diff_euler_convolution = Q_euler - Q_convolution
diff_rk45_convolution = Q_rk45 - Q_convolution
axes[1].plot(t_eval, diff_euler_convolution, label="Euler - Convolution")
axes[1].plot(t_eval, diff_rk45_convolution, label="RK45 - Convolution")
axes[1].set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
axes[1].set_ylabel(r"$\Delta Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
axes[1].legend()
```



So these are not identical, although RK45 is closer to the convolution solution than the explicit Euler method. This is to be expected, as both RK45 and `scipy.integrate.quad` have numerical error control, while the explicit Euler method does not.

Lastly, we can also do numerical ODE integration for an n -th order linear reservoir with a time-varying input $I(t)$.

```
def ode_func_nth_order(t: float, S: np.array, I_func, K: float, n: int):
    dSdt = np.zeros_like(S)
    dSdt[0] = I_func(t) - S[0] / K
    if n > 1:
        for i in range(1, n):
            dSdt[i] = S[i - 1] / K - S[i] / K
    return dSdt
```

This can be solved with both solvers. $S^{(i)} = 0$ for all i .

```

S_n_EE_dict = {}
S_n_RK45_dict = {}
n_num_list = [1,2,3,5]
for n_num in n_num_list:
    S0 = np.zeros(n_num) # Initial storage
    S_n_EE_dict[n_num] = explicit_euler(ode_func_nth_order, t_span, S0,
↪ delta_t, (I_func, K_num, n_num))
    S_n_RK45_dict[n_num] = rk_45(ode_func_nth_order, t_span, S0, (I_func,
↪ K_num, n_num))

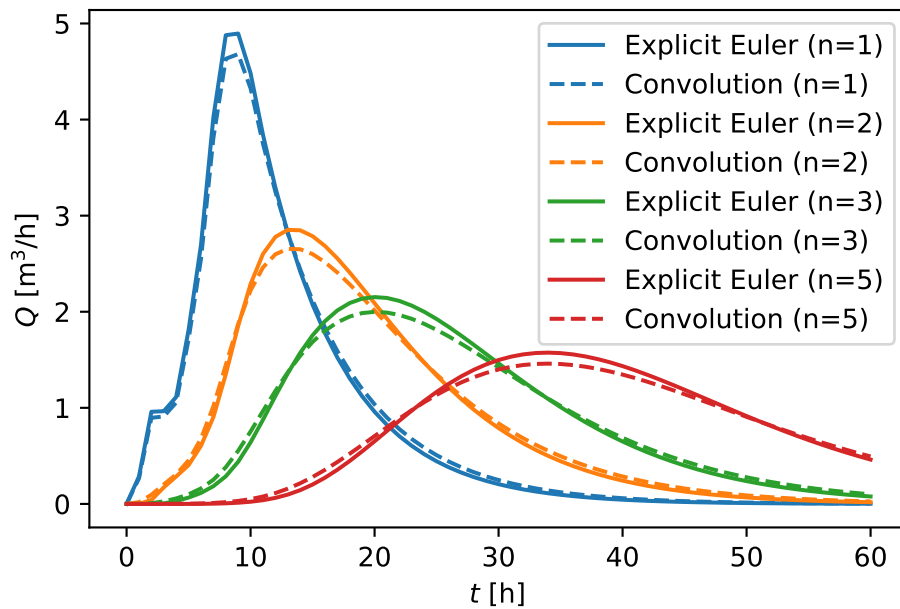
```

Comparing Explicit Euler to the convolution:

```

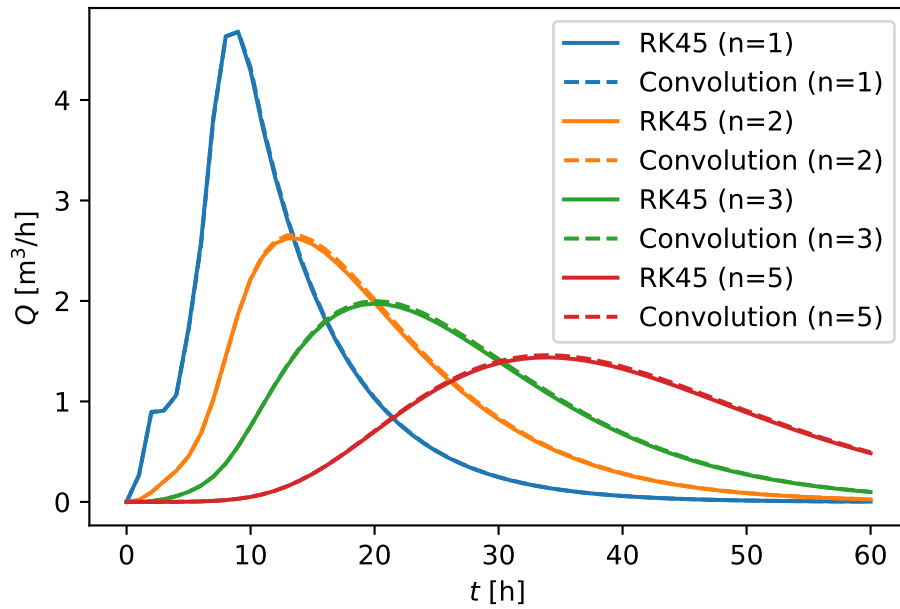
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
colors = plt.get_cmap("tab10").colors
for i, n_num in enumerate(n_num_list):
    Q_n_EE = S_n_EE_dict[n_num][n_num - 1, :] / K_num
    ax.plot(t_eval, Q_n_EE, label=f"Explicit Euler (n={n_num})",
↪ color=colors[i])
    Q_n_convolution = Q_numerical_dict[n_num]
    ax.plot(
        t_eval,
        Q_n_convolution,
        label=f"Convolution (n={n_num})",
        linestyle="--",
        color=colors[i],
    )
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.set_ylabel(r"$Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
ax.legend()

```



and RK45 to the convolution:

```
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
for i, n_num in enumerate(n_num_list):
    Q_n_RK45 = S_n_RK45_dict[n_num][n_num - 1, :] / K_num
    ax.plot(t_eval, Q_n_RK45, label=f"RK45 (n={n_num})", color=colors[i])
    Q_n_convolution = Q_numerical_dict[n_num]
    ax.plot(
        t_eval,
        Q_n_convolution,
        label=f"Convolution (n={n_num})",
        linestyle="--",
        color=colors[i],
    )
ax.set_xlabel(r"$t$ [h]")
ax.set_ylabel(r"$Q$ [m$^3$/h]")
ax.legend()
```



The same conclusions as before can be drawn: the RK45 method is closer to the convolution solution than the explicit Euler method. The most important takeaway is that both the convolution approach and the numerical ODE integration can be applied to linear systems with time-varying inputs and yield practically identical results when numerical error in the solvers are controlled.